

5. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List-I (Ocean)	List-II (Deepest Point)
A. Pacific Ocean	1. Java Trench
B. Atlantic Ocean	2. Eurasian Basin
C. Indian Ocean	3. Mariana Trench
D. Arctic Ocean	4. Puerto Rico Trench

Code :

A	B	C	D
(a) 4	3	2	1
(b) 3	4	1	2
(c) 1	3	4	2
(d) 2	4	3	1

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (b)

Ocean	Deepest Point
Pacific Ocean	- Mariana Trench
Atlantic Ocean	- Puerto Rico Trench
Indian Ocean	- Java (Sunda) Trench
Arctic Ocean	- Eurasian Basin

6. Sunda trench lies parallel to the island of -

- (a) Java (b) Maldives
(c) Sumatra (d) Mauritius
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above.

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (e)

Sunda Trench is a deep submarine depression in the eastern Indian Ocean that extends some 2,000 miles (3,200 km) in a northwest-southeast arc along the southwestern and southern Indonesian archipelago. It is located about 190 miles (305 km) off the southwestern coasts of the islands of Sumatra and Java, stretching eastward south of the western Lesser Sunda Islands.

7. Match List - I with List - II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists.

List - I (Ocean)	List -II (Maximum Deepest Point)
A. Pacific	1. Sunda Trench
B. Arctic	2. Puerto Rico Trench
C. Indian	3. Mariana Trench
D. Atlantic	4. Molloy deep

Code :

(a) Northern					(b) Challenger
(c) Manhattan					(d) Richards
	A	B	C	D	
(a)	3	2	1	4	
(b)	3	4	1	2	
(c)	4	3	2	1	
(d)	1	2	3	4	

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

(Ocean)	(Maximum Deepest Point)
Pacific	Mariana Trench
Arctic	Molloy deep
Indian	Sunda Trench
Atlantic	Puerto Rico Trench

Rivers of the World

*River is known as 'cradle of civilization' and Asia is known as birthplace of every religion.

*Mesopotamian civilization nurtured in the region enclosed by the Dajla-Farat (Tigris-Euphrates) river system and the Harappa civilization prospered in Indus River System.

*The longest river in Asia is the **Yangtze River** which flows through China and drains into the Pacific Ocean. The Yangtze is 6300 km long.

***Mekong River** has its source in the Tibetan Plateau from where it runs through China's Yunnan Province, Myanmar, Laos, Thailand, Cambodia, Vietnam and finally drains into the South China Sea.

*The river **Salween** has its source in the Tibetan plateau from where it flows into Myanmar, and drains into the Bay of Martaban of Andaman Sea in south-east Asia after travelling a distance of 2815 km.

It makes border between Myanmar and Thailand. *The river **Amur** is 2897 km (4440 km. if the Argun river is included) long. It creates the border between Mongolia, Russia and China before it drains into the Pacific ocean (near Tartary strait).

***Indus** is the most important river of Pakistan. River Indus is joined by rivers - Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, Beas, Sutlej, Kabul etc. before it drains into the Arabian Sea.

*River **Irrawaddy** is called the lifeline of the country Myanmar. River Huang Ho is a river that flows through the Northern part of China. The basin of this river is the birthplace of the ancient Chinese civilization. The river is also called the yellow river, because of the yellow coloured soil found

in this region.

*River **Mahaweli Ganga** (335 km) is the longest river in Sri Lanka. It flows in North-East direction and drains into the Bay of Bengal.

*The River **Tigris** rises in the Taurus Mountains of Eastern Turkiye. The river flows south Turkiye and then through Syria (Syria - Turkiye border). Tigris is joined by River Euphrates in Iraq and then the collective stream drains into the Persian Gulf near Basra.

***Amu Darya** and **Syr Darya** are two important rivers of Central Asia. Both the rivers have different sources from where they emerge but both drain into the Aral Sea.

*Amur, Ob and Lena are important rivers of Russia which Amur flows in North-east direction and Ob and Lena flow in northward from their source.

*River **Volga** is the longest river in Europe. It rises in the Valdai hills and drains in the Caspian Sea.

*The **Danube** is the second longest river after Volga. It originates in Germany and drains into the Black Sea.

*River **Dnieper** originates in the western parts of Moscow and drains into the Black sea.

*River **Ural** originates in the southern Ural mountains and discharges into the Caspian Sea.

*River Rhine originates from the Swiss Alps. The river flows through a rift valley and drains into the North Sea. The famous city of Bonn (Germany) is situated on the bank of the River Rhine.

*The Rhine is the busiest inland waterway of Europe.

*River Po is the most important river of Italy, also known as the Ganga of Italy. It is also the longest river in Italy.

*River **Tiber** rises in the Apennine Mountains (Italy) and drains into the Tyrrhenian sea. The city of Rome is situated on the bank of this river.

*River **Don** rises from the western Russian near the city of Tula oblast and drains into the sea of Azov.

*River **Ebro** of Spain originates in the Cantabrian Mountains and drains into the Mediterranean sea.

*River **Thames** is the longest river of England and the second longest in the United Kingdom after the River severn.

*The **Nile** is a major river in North-Eastern Africa (app. 6695 km). It is an international river. 10 countries of Nile basin Initiative namely- Tanzania, Uganda, Rwanda, Burundi, the Democratic Republic of the Congo, Kenya, Ethiopia, South Sudan, Sudan and Egypt are the member of the Nile Basin initiative (NBI) and Eritrea is an observer. The River finally drains into the Mediterranean sea. The River originates from

the Victoria Lake as **White Nile**. Here it is known as Victoria Nile. However, the latest's researches conducted have stated that the actual source of white Nile is in Nyungwe Forests located near lake Kivu in south Rawanda. The **Blue Nile** is the most important tributary of white Nile. The Blue Nile originates at **Lake Tana** in Ethiopia.

*The **White Nile** and the **Blue Nile** meet in the Sudan capital of Khartoum and the collective water body is known as the River Nile. The fertile silt and abundance of fresh water from the river is most cherished by the country Egypt. As a result, Egypt is also known as the Gift of Nile. The River Nile is like an Oasis for those arid regions that fall in her course.

*River **Niger** is a river in West Africa that rises from Fouta Djallon Highlands and discharges into the Gulf of Guinea in the Atlantic Ocean.

*River **Limpopo** of Africa crosses the **Tropic of Capricorn** twice.

***Congo** River known as the River Zaire is the second longest river in Africa and has a total length of 4374 km. It crosses the **equator twice**. Victoria Falls is a waterfall on the River Zambezi. The **Kariba Dam** has been constructed on this river.

*The essential rivers of North America are- **St. Lawrence, Yukon, Missouri, Mississippi, Colorado, Mackenzie, Columbia, Hudson, Nelson and Fraser**.

*The source of river Mississippi is the Lake Itasca in Minnesota. Ohio, Arkansas and Red river are the main tributaries of the river Mississippi. The Mississippi River drains into the Gulf of Mexico. It is noteworthy to mention that the Great Plains of North America were formed by the Mississippi and Missouri rivers. The Mississippi - Missouri-Jefferson river system is the largest river system in North America. Its total length is 6275 km.

*Yukon is a river in North America that flows through the state of Alaska (U.S.A.) and Canada. The upper half of the river flows through Canada. Its total length is 3185 km.

***Mackenzie River** is the longest river in Canada. The river originates in the **Great Slave Lake** of North-western Canada and drains into the Arctic Ocean. The total length of the river Mackenzie is 1738 km.

*The **Saint Lawrence River** connects the Great Lakes to Atlantic Ocean. The river is part of the international boundary between the United states of America and Canada. *River **Rio Grande** is a part of the International border between USA and Mexico. It drains into the Gulf of Mexico.

*River **Columbia** originates in the Rocky Mountains of British Columbia (Canada) and drains into the Pacific Ocean.

*River **Hudson** originates in the Adirondack Mountains of New York (USA) and drains into the Atlantic Ocean.

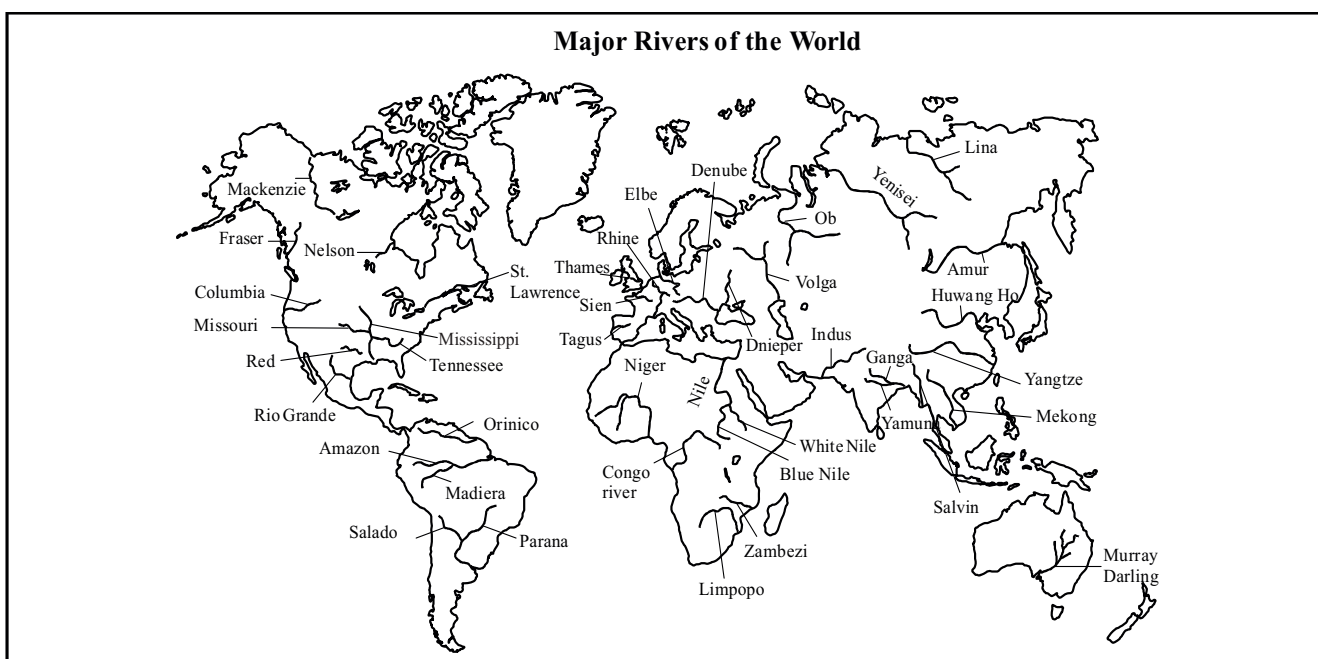
*The Orinoco, Amazon and Plata river basins form the major portion of the Plains of South America. The Amazon River of South America is the longest river on the continent and is the largest river in the world both in terms of volume and drainage area covered. Its length is 6437 km and is navigable

up to 1600 km. The Orinoco River Basin is Venezuela (65%) and the remaining portion is in Colombia (35%). **Parana** River originates in the Brazilian Highlands.

*River **Murray** and **Darling** River are the two most important rivers in Australia. The **Murray-Darling Valley** is the most important agrarian region in Australia.

*The three longest rivers in the world are as follows :

(1) Nile River (6695 km), (2) Amazon River (6437 km), (3) Yangtze River (6300 km).



1. Consider the following pairs :

- | (River) | (Flows into) |
|------------|--------------|
| 1. Mekong | Andaman Sea |
| 2. Thames | Irish Sea |
| 3. Volga | Caspian Sea |
| 4. Zambezi | Indian Ocean |

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 2 and 4 only

I.A.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

Volga is the longest river in Europe carrying largest volume of water. It drains into Caspian Sea.
Zambezi River either crosses or runs along the borders of six countries - Angola, Zambia, Namibia, Botswana, Zimbabwe

and Mozambique and finally drains into Indian Ocean.

Thames River originates in the Cotswold Hills and drains into North Sea.

Mekong is the longest river in Southeast Asia. It drains into the South China Sea.

2. The largest river of the world in terms of drainage area, is-

- (a) Nile (b) Amazon
(c) Congo (d) Mississippi-Missouri

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1999, 2000

Ans. (b)

South America's Amazon River is the largest river in terms of its volume of flow in the world. Its drainage area is about 70 lakhs square km. and its length is approximately 6,437 km.

In terms of length, the longest river of the world is the Nile which flows in East Africa for a distance of 6,695 km. Congo River flows in Central Africa and covers a distance of about 4,374 km crossing the equator twice during its flow. Its drainage area is about 3,822,000 square km. Mississippi-Missouri river system is located in North America and it is the largest river system in North America.

3. Which one of the following rivers is the second longest river of the world?

- (a) Nile (b) Amazon
(c) Mississippi - Missouri (d) Yangtze

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

Amazon River in South America is the largest and the second longest river in the world after the Nile. The basin of Amazon belongs to Brazil, Peru, Bolivia, Venezuela, Colombia, Ecuador, Guyana, French Guiana and Suriname.

4. Which of the following rivers crosses the Equator twice?

- (a) Zaire (b) Niger
(c) Nil (d) Amazon

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Congo River is also known as 'Zaire River' is the second largest river after the Amazon on the African continent. It crosses the Equator twice.

5. Which one of the following is a part of the Congo Basin?

- (a) Cameroon (b) Nigeria
(c) South Sudan (d) Uganda

I.A.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

According to World Wildlife Fund (WWF), the Congo Basin spans across six countries - Cameroon, Central African Republic, Democratic Republic of the Congo, Republic of the Congo, Equatorial Guinea and Gabon.

6. Which one among the following rivers is the longest?

- (a) Amazon (b) Amur
(c) Congo (d) Lena

I.A.S. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (a)

The world's three longest rivers and their respective lengths are given below :

(River Name)	(Length)
Nile	6695 km
Amazon	6437 km
Yangtze	6300 km

7. The longest river of South America –

- (a) Nile (b) Amazon
(c) Mississippi (d) Ganga

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Amazon is the longest river in South America. This river is about 6437 km long. Ships can sail up to a distance of 1,600 km. Apart from this, Nile (6,695 km) in Africa, Mississippi (3779 km) in U.S.A., and the Ganga (2,525 km) in India are the prominent rivers. In terms of length the Nile River is the longest river in the world. Countries like South Sudan, D.R. Congo, Ethiopia, Eritrea, Kenya, Rwanda, Tanzania, Uganda, Burundi, Sudan and Egypt are part of drainage basin of the Nile River. Nile River, flows into the Mediterranean Sea.

8. Which of the following countries is not under the drainage area of the Nile river-

- (a) Chad (b) Ethiopia
(c) Sudan (d) Uganda

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

Countries like Burundi, Rwanda, D.R. Congo, Ethiopia, Sudan, South Sudan, Tanzania, Kenya, Eritrea, Uganda and Egypt are part of the drainage basin of the Nile river. 'Chad' does not come under the drainage basin of River Nile. Therefore, option (a) is the correct answer.

9. The Blue Nile river originates from

- (a) Lake Victoria (b) Lake Tana
(c) Lake Edward (d) Lake Albert

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

The Blue Nile river originates from Lake Tana in Ethiopia. The upper course of the river is called the Abbay in Ethiopia.

10. Assertion (A) : Egypt is the Gift of the Nile.

Reason (R) : It is an oasis of the Sahara desert.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (a)

Most of the population of Egypt benefits from the fertile land and water sources of the Nile river. Therefore, Egypt is called the Gift of the Nile. The region through which river Nile flows is like an oasis in the desert.

11. Consider the map given below :
The river shown on the map is :



- (a) Irrawaddy
(b) Mekong
(c) Chao Phraya
(d) Salween

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

Above map is related to Myanmar, On its eastern part from north to south, River Salween is shown to be flowing on the map. River Salween emerges from the Tibetan Plateau and covering a distance of 2,815 km falls into the Andaman Sea.

12. Which one of the following rivers of Asia flows towards the south ?

- (a) Amur (b) Lena
(c) Ob (d) Salween

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (d)

Amur flows towards north-east direction and Lena and Ob rivers flow towards the north from their origin while the Salween River flows towards the south from its origin.

13. Which one of the following pairs (River — Direction) is not correctly matched?

- (a) Amur river — North-East
(b) Syr Darya — North-West
(c) Angara river — North
(d) Mekong river — South-West

UPPSC (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

The Mekong River originated from the Tibetan Plateau (China) and flows southeast for about 4900 to 5000 km. before emptying into South China Sea. This river flows through China, Myanmar, Thailand, Laos, Cambodia and Vietnam.
- The Amur River flows northeast from its source and empties into the Pacific Ocean (Tartary Strait).

- The Syr Darya River flows northwest from its source and empties into the Aral Sea.
- The Angara River initially flows north from its source, then turns westward and merges with Yenisei River. The Yenisei River ultimately empties into the Arctic Ocean.

14. The largest river of Asia is –

- (a) Indus (b) Brahmaputra
(c) Yangtze (d) Hwang Ho

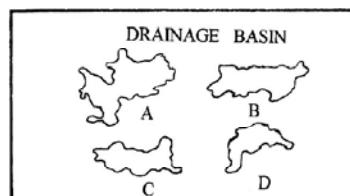
U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

The Yangtze river, with a length of 6,300 km., is the longest Asian river in Asia. It flows in China and falls into the East China Sea (Pacific Ocean). The lengths of other rivers are - Indus - 2880 km, Brahmaputra - 2900 km, Hwang Ho (Yellow River) - 5464 km.

15. Match the drainage basins labelled as A,B,C and D with the names listed below and select the correct answer using the code given below the names of the drainage basins.

Name of drainage basins:



1. Ganga-Brahmaputra

2. Indus

3. Parana

4. Zambezi

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	1	2	4
(b)	1	3	4	2
(c)	1	3	2	4
(d)	3	1	4	2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (d)

The correct order of drainage basins mentioned in the question are as follows :

A - Parana (South America)

B - Ganga-Brahmaputra (Asia)

C - Zambezi (Africa)

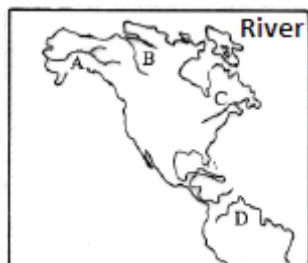
D - Indus (Asia)

Hence, option (d) is the correct option.

16. Match rivers labeled A,B,C and D on the given map with their names given in the list and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists :

List-I

- | | |
|-----------------|------------|
| 1. St. Lawrence | 2. Orinoco |
| 3. Mackenzie | 4. Amazon |
| 5. Yukon | |



Code :

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| | A | B | C | D |
| (a) | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| (b) | 5 | 3 | 1 | 2 |
| (c) | 5 | 4 | 1 | 3 |
| (d) | 3 | 1 | 4 | 2 |

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (b)

Rivers A, B, C, & D mentioned in the given map are as follows:

(A) Yukon River: It is major North American river that flows through the central Yukon Territory of northwestern Canada and the central region of Alaska a state of the U.S.

(B) Mackenzie River: Rising out of Great Slave Lake, the Mackenzie River flows generally northwest in Canada. It finally empties into the Beaufort Sea, part of the Arctic Ocean, through the vast Mackenzie Delta. 1738 km. long Mackenzie river is the longest River in Canada.

(C) Saint Lawrence River: This river connects Great Lakes to the Atlantic Ocean. It forms an international boundary between the United States of America and Canada.

(D) Orinoco River: Approximately 65 percent of this river basin is in Venezuela and remaining portion is in Colombia. It is 2150 km long.

17. Syr and Amu rivers fall into-

- | | |
|-----------------|---------------|
| (a) Caspian sea | (b) Black sea |
| (c) Baltic sea | (d) Aral sea |

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2012

Ans. (d)

The Amu Darya and the Syr Darya are prominent rivers of Central Asia that flow into the Aral Sea.

18. The river duo, which falls into the Black Sea are –

- | | |
|-------------------|--------------------|
| (a) Volga- Danube | (b) Dnieper- Volga |
|-------------------|--------------------|

- | | |
|---------------------|-----------------|
| (c) Dnieper- Danube | (d) Ural- Volga |
|---------------------|-----------------|

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

Dnieper River : This river rises in the west of Moscow and flows to the Black Sea.

Danube River: It is the second longest river in Europe after the Volga. It rises in Germany and flows for 2,857 miles to its mouth on the Black Sea.

Volga River: This is the longest river in Europe, It rises in the Valdai Hills northwest of Moscow and flows into the Caspian Sea.

Ural River: It rises in the Ural Mountains near Mount Kruglaya and flows into the Caspian Sea.

19. River Volga falls into :

- | | |
|---------------|-----------------------|
| (a) Red Sea | (b) Caspian Sea |
| (c) Black Sea | (d) Mediterranean Sea |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

20. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I

- A. Lena**
B. Amur
C. Tigris
D. Mahi

List-II

- 1. Persian Gulf**
2. Arctic Ocean
3. Arabian Sea
4. Pacific Ocean

Code :

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| | A | B | C | D |
| (a) | 2 | 4 | 1 | 3 |
| (b) | 3 | 2 | 4 | 1 |
| (c) | 4 | 1 | 3 | 2 |
| (d) | 1 | 3 | 2 | 4 |

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

The correct match is as follows:

(Rivers)	(Emptying into)
Lena (Russia)	- Arctic Ocean
Amur (Russia, China and Mongolia)-	Pacific Ocean
Tigris (Turkiye, Syria, Iraq)	- Persian Gulf
Mahi (Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, Gujarat)	- Arabian Ocean

Thus, option (a) has the correct code.

21. Which of the following river flows through a rift valley ?

- | | |
|------------|-----------|
| (a) Amazon | (b) Indus |
|------------|-----------|

(c) Volga

(d) Rhine

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (d)

The Rhine river emerges at the Swiss Alps and flowing through a rift valley empties into the North Sea. Famous German city Bonn is located on the banks of the river Rhine.

22. In which sea do river Elbe and river Rhine drain their water?

- (a) North Sea
- (b) Mediterranean Sea
- (c) Adriatic Sea
- (d) Black Sea
- (e) Question not attempted

Raj. P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

River Elbe and River Rhine drain their water in to the North Sea. Significantly, the Elbe is one of Europe's major rivers. The Elbe River Basin covers an area of approximately 1.5 lakh km².

23. Which of the following is not related to Asia?

- (a) Lop Nor
- (b) Amur
- (c) Niger
- (d) Tigris

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

Lop Nor: Lop Nor is saline lake in China.

Amur river : The length of the Amur river is 2897 (4440 km. if the Argun river is included). The Amur forms a border between Russia, Mongolia and China.

Niger river: The Niger rises in the Fouta Djallon Highlands of Western Africa and empties into the Gulf of Guinea. It is related to Africa, not Asia.

Tigris river: It rises in Taurus Mountains of eastern Turkiye. It meets Euphrates River in Iraq and merges into the Persian Gulf.

24. Which of the following river of Africa crosses tropic of Capricorn twice?

- (a) Zambezi
- (b) Limpopo
- (c) Congo
- (d) Niger

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (b)

Limpopo river of Africa crosses tropic of Capricorn twice.

25. The country which provides the best example of radial drainage is

- (a) Australia
- (b) France

(c) Sri Lanka

(d) Zaire

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (c)

The southern central region of Sri Lanka is the tallest highland which rises to 1,500 metres above sea-level. The altitude decreases towards plains from this highland gradually. This plain is narrow in the western and southwestern regions and widest in the north. The rivers of Sri Lanka rise in the central highlands and flow in a radial pattern towards the sea. Most of these rivers are short. Mahaweli is the longest river in Sri Lanka. Flowing towards northeast, it merges into Bay of Bengal.

26. Mahaweli Ganga is a river of –

- (a) Bangladesh
- (b) India
- (c) Sri Lanka
- (d) Nepal

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (c)

The rivers of Sri Lanka are short and flow in a radial pattern outwards from the central highlands. The Mahaweli river is the longest river (335 km) in Sri Lanka starting from the Hatton plateau on the western side of Sri Lanka and flowing into the Bay of Bengal.

27. Which of the following pair is not correctly matched ?

River	Country
(a) Dnieper	Ukraine
(b) Po	Italy
(c) Rhine	Germany
(d) Rhone	Spain

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (d)

Passing through the city of Geneva Switzerland Rhone river falls into Bay of Lions in the Mediterranean Sea. Dnieper - Ukraine, Po - Italy and Rhine - Germany are correctly matched.

28. The great Asian river the Mekong does not flow through:

- (a) China
- (b) Malaysia
- (c) Cambodia
- (d) Laos

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

The **Mekong** is a trans-boundary river in Southeast Asia. From the Tibetan Plateau, the river flows through China's Yunnan province, Myanmar, Laos, Thailand, Cambodia and Vietnam and falls into South China Sea. The Mekong river does not flow through Malaysia.